

5.4 AREAS OF STUDY

The Areas of Study define the subject content through the study of which candidates develop their aural perception, musical knowledge and understanding of:

- the use of musical elements, devices, tonalities and structures;
- the use of resources, conventions, processes and relevant notations including staff notation;
- the contextual influences that affect the way music is created, performed and heard (for example, the effect of different intentions, uses, venues, occasions, available resources and the cultural environment).

The content of each Area of Study is set out under four headings:

The **Starting Point** defines the broad area of knowledge which provides the background for the in-depth studies defined in the core. The Starting Points are designed to enable teachers to draw on experiences and understanding developed in Key Stage 3 and to lead into more detailed study.

The **Core** defines the in-depth understanding that is central to the Area of Study. It provides the particular focus for more detailed learning.

Links indicate opportunities for teachers to draw together materials from different Areas of Study in ways which will lead to more integrated understanding.

Language for Learning lists the terminology which candidates should encounter in the Area of Study. This will be drawn on in the Listening Paper. A summary list of all the Language for Learning is provided in Appendix A for ease of reference.